

does a pretty good job as a CMS, making it easy to maintain your site, and update your content. Of course, it does this best with the help of a good theme, and some great plugins. The strength of WordPress is the community of developers who have already done almost anything you can think of with it. Here are the best plugins we've run across, the ones we install for nearly all of our client's sites.

1. Cforms II - <http://deliciousdays.com/cforms-plugin>

This is far and away the best contact form plugin there is. The reason? configurability. You can easily build literally anything with it. We've built out employment application forms, wedding checklists, and more for clients. It also drives our own quote form. There's also built in spam protection, via question and answer or captcha.

2. WP e-Commerce - <http://www.instinct.co.nz/e-commerce/>

Unlike cforms, this plugin has no competition. It provides an easy way to manage storefront and shopping cart as an integral part of your WordPress installation. It includes the ability to sell digital downloads as well, which is great for photographers, musicians, and authors. By default it includes support for PayPal, although the \$29.99 fee for the authorize.net module will pay for itself in lower fees for most serious e-Commerce sites.

3. Google Sitemap Generator

<http://www.arnebrachhold.de/redir/sitemap-home/>

The biggest benefit of using WordPress is the manual labor you save because the software already knows where all of your content is. This Plugin submits a comprehensive index of your site to Google, Yahoo, MSN Live, and Ask.com every time you update your site. It's a huge boost to your site's SEO.

4. Event Calendar 3 - <http://wpcal.firetree.net/>

There are a ton of event plugins out there. This is the best & most integrated one we've used. It provides an iCal feed, in addition to the standard RSS feed. Since the events are created as Blog posts, it's easy to integrate them into your site.

5. Page Links To - <http://txfx.net/code/wordpress/page-links-to/>

By far the simplest plugin on this list, This plugin allows you to create "pages" that link to something else. It's the easiest way to add links to your main menu, without mucking around in code. It's good for adding a link to an external